

## 2026 Medical Plans at a Glance

Effective January 1, 2026, UnitedHealthcare (UHC) will replace BlueCross BlueShield of Illinois as the administrator of all four plans. As always, Northwestern's goal is to provide comprehensive, competitive medical coverage.

**IMPORTANT!** To be covered under a Northwestern-sponsored medical plan in 2026, you must elect medical coverage during the Open Enrollment period.

### Four medical plans will be available to Northwestern faculty and staff:

- **PPO:** You pay a copay for certain medical services (for example, office visits with your primary care physician or a specialist). For most other covered medical services, this plan provides benefits based on coinsurance once you meet the annual deductible. If you choose this plan, you can receive services from any provider you choose, but you will pay less out of pocket and receive more plan benefits from an in-network provider.
- **HSA Plus or HSA Essential:** Once you meet the annual deductible, these plans provide benefits for covered medical services based on coinsurance. Refer to chart on the next page for plan differences. If you choose one of these plans, you can receive services from any provider you choose, but you will pay less out of pocket and receive more plan benefits from an in-network provider. You can make pretax contributions to a [Health Savings Account](#) (HSA) with matching University contributions. You can use the pretax money in the HSA to pay for eligible health care expenses or invest it.
- **HMO:** Once you pay any applicable copay, this plan pays the full cost of covered services you receive from a provider who is a member of the HMO network. This plan pays no benefits for services from an out-of-network provider except for emergency medical care.

### Other Coverage Information:

- All four plans pay 100% of the cost of applicable preventive care.
- The PPO, HSA Plus, and HSA Essential Plans utilize the same list of [in-network providers](#) and provide coverage for the same services.
- The HSA Plus and HSA Essential Plans receive the same University match for the [Health Savings Account](#). The University match has **not changed** from 2025 to 2026.
- For the HMO, you must select your [in-network](#) primary care provider with UHC before you can schedule an appointment with the provider.
- You will be enrolled automatically in [prescription drug](#) coverage with CVS Caremark.

### Resources:

- Watch [medical plan overview video](#)
- Review online [FAQs](#)
- Review [website](#) to learn how to avoid the Tobacco \$50 per month surcharge

| 2026 Medical Plans                           |                                                                  |                                        |                                |                            |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Plan Features                                | PPO <sup>1, 2, 3, 5</sup>                                        | HSA Plus <sup>2,4,5</sup>              | HSA Essential <sup>2,3,5</sup> | HMO <sup>1</sup>           |
| In-Network Providers                         |                                                                  |                                        |                                |                            |
| Deductible<br>(Individual/Family)            | \$750/\$1,500                                                    | \$2,000/\$4,000                        | \$4,000/\$8,000                | Not applicable             |
| Coinsurance                                  | 20%                                                              | 20%                                    |                                |                            |
| Out-of-Pocket Maximum<br>(Individual/Family) | \$3,000/\$6,000                                                  | \$4,000/\$8,000                        | \$7,000/\$14,000               | \$1,500/\$3,000            |
| Office Visit                                 | \$40 Primary Care Physician/\$55 specialist                      | 20% Coinsurance after Deductible       |                                | \$25 PCP/\$35 specialist   |
| ER                                           | \$150 (waived if admitted)<br>+ 20% Coinsurance after Deductible |                                        |                                | \$150 (waived if admitted) |
| Out-of-Network Providers                     |                                                                  |                                        |                                |                            |
| Deductible<br>(Individual/Family)            | \$1,500/\$3,000                                                  | \$4,000/\$8,000                        | \$8,000/\$16,000               | Not applicable             |
| Coinsurance                                  | 40%                                                              | 40%                                    |                                |                            |
| Out-of-Pocket Maximum<br>(Individual/Family) | \$6,000/ \$12,000                                                | \$8,000/\$16,000                       | \$14,000/\$28,000              |                            |
| Office Visit                                 | 40% Coinsurance after Deductible                                 |                                        |                                |                            |
| ER                                           | \$150 (waived if admitted)<br>+ 20% Coinsurance after Deductible | 20% Coinsurance after Deductible       |                                | \$150 (waived if admitted) |
| Health Savings Account Eligibility           |                                                                  |                                        |                                |                            |
| University Match                             | n/a                                                              | Employee Only \$1,000 / Family \$2,000 |                                | n/a                        |

<sup>1</sup> Copays apply toward out-of-pocket maximums.

<sup>2</sup> The in- and out-of-network deductibles and in- and out-of-network out-of-pocket maximums are tracked separately.

<sup>3</sup> Each family member has an individual deductible within the overall family deductible. Once a member meets theirs, coinsurance begins for that person; even if the full family deductible isn't met. The remaining family deductible must be met by any combination of other members before their coinsurance begins.

<sup>4</sup> For You + Spouse, You + Child(ren), or You + Spouse + Child(ren) coverage the Family deductible must be met before coinsurance coverage begins for any individual member.

<sup>5</sup> Each family member has an individual out-of-pocket maximum (OOPM) within the overall family OOPM. Once a member meets theirs, plan pays 100% for that person; even if the full family OOPM isn't met. The remaining family OOPM must be met by any combination of other members.

## Enhanced Customer Support: Answers to all Your Questions

The UHC support model will allow faculty and staff to contact UHC directly in three different ways:

1. For general questions about medical coverage, contact UHC at **833-314-1787 for PPO** and HSA plans or **855-828-7715 for HMO** plan.
2. For those with questions regarding complex or ongoing conditions, you may [schedule](#) a one-on-one meeting with UHC to discuss how your treatment will be covered and any transition of care questions. You may also email [northwestern@uhc.com](mailto:northwestern@uhc.com) your questions to UHC directly.
3. If your provider is not in-network, see the nomination tool on the UHC benefits [website](#) to request UHC invite them to join the network.

If you are unable to obtain information from UHC via the 800 number, a 1:1 consultation, or from the email address (after at least 2 business days), you may email [benefits@northwestern.edu](mailto:benefits@northwestern.edu) for additional support. General questions can be sent to the askHR Service Center at [askHR@northwestern.edu](mailto:askHR@northwestern.edu) or **847-491-4700**.

## Finding In-network Providers

1. Navigate to the UHC Find a Doctor [website](#)
2. Select *Search as a Guest* found on the right side of the page
3. Select either *Medical Directory* or *Behavioral Health Directory* based on the type of care you need
4. Select *Employer and Individual Plans*
5. Scroll and select *Choice Plus* for the PPO or HSA plans; select *Navigate HMO* for the HMO plan.
6. Select *Change Location*, enter your ZIP code in the search bar, click *Update Location*.

## Virtual Visits

UHC offers access to [virtual care](#) for a variety of care needs. To get started, sign in at [myuhc.com/virtualvisits](https://myuhc.com/virtualvisits), call the number on your health plan ID card, or download the UnitedHealthcare app.

- [24/7 Virtual Visits](#) are a way to schedule same-day, urgent care visits, so you can talk with a provider 24/7 for common urgent care needs or when your primary care provider (PCP) is not available.
- Access to [primary care](#) and [specialist providers](#) without the office visit.

| 2026 Prescription Drug Coverage                     |                        |                               |                               |                        |
|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------|
| Plan Features                                       | PPO <sup>1, 2, 4</sup> | HSA Plus <sup>3</sup>         | HSA Essential <sup>3</sup>    | HMO <sup>1, 2, 4</sup> |
| <b>Out-of-Pocket Maximum</b><br>(Individual/Family) | \$1,500/\$3,000        | \$4,000/\$8,000               | \$7,000/\$14,000              | \$1,500/\$10,200       |
| <b>Prescription Drugs</b><br>(Retail/Mail Order)    | Copay:                 | Coinsurance after deductible: | Coinsurance after deductible: | Copay:                 |
| Generic                                             | \$10 /\$20             | 20%/20%                       | 20%/20%                       | \$10/\$20              |
| Formulary                                           | \$50/\$100             | 20%/20%                       | 20%/20%                       | \$30/\$60              |
| Non-Formulary                                       | \$75/\$150             | 20%/20%                       | 20%/20%                       | \$60/\$120             |
| Specialty                                           | \$100/\$200            | 20%/20%                       | 20%/20%                       | \$90/\$180             |

<sup>1</sup> Out-of-pocket maximums for medical and Rx are tracked separately.

<sup>2</sup> Rx copays apply toward out-of-pocket maximums.

<sup>3</sup> Out-of-pocket maximums for medical and Rx are combined.

<sup>4</sup> Family out-of-pocket maximum is \$1,500 per individual until the family limit is reached.

### ***Applies to all Medical Plans***

- [Generics preferred](#): Ancillary charges apply to brand-name if generic available, even when Dispense as Written box is checked.
- [CVS Retail 90 Network](#): Select long-term [medications](#) require a 90-day supply and must be filled at Walgreens, CVS, and CVS Mail Order only.
- [Specialty drugs](#): Must be filled through CVS Specialty pharmacy, even if administered at your doctor's office or an infusion center.

### **PPO and HMO Only**

- [PrudentRx](#): If your specialty medication is noted on the [PrudentRx Drug List](#), you **must** participate in the PrudentRx program. Under the program you will receive your medications free of charge (\$0).

### **Resources**

- To verify if your medication is covered under the plan, you may contact CVS Caremark directly at 833-844-5348 or by reviewing the [search tools by medical plan on the website](#).
- Review the online [FAQs](#) to find answers to common questions about prescription drug questions.

Review the [website](#) to learn how to avoid the \$50 per month Tobacco Surcharge

| 2026 Monthly Premiums for Medical Plans |           |           |           |           |               |           |           |           |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|---------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| Coverage/Salary Tier                    | PPO       |           | HSA Plus  |           | HSA Essential |           | HMO       |           |
|                                         | Full-Time | Part-Time | Full-Time | Part-Time | Full-Time     | Part-Time | Full-Time | Part-Time |
| <b>You Only</b>                         |           |           |           |           |               |           |           |           |
| Under \$42,000                          | 63        | 369       | 37        | 316       | 27            | 281       | 47        | 299       |
| \$42,001–\$75,000                       | 116       | 400       | 81        | 346       | 52            | 295       | 105       | 338       |
| \$75,001–\$128,000                      | 197       | 458       | 148       | 391       | 117           | 340       | 170       | 381       |
| \$128,001–\$182,000                     | 278       | 510       | 222       | 441       | 182           | 382       | 248       | 433       |
| \$182,001 and over                      | 434       | 616       | 345       | 521       | 292           | 457       | 393       | 531       |
| <b>You &amp; Spouse</b>                 |           |           |           |           |               |           |           |           |
| Under \$42,000                          | 138       | 805       | 83        | 693       | 59            | 612       | 102       | 652       |
| \$42,001–\$75,000                       | 254       | 880       | 180       | 757       | 115           | 647       | 228       | 736       |
| \$75,001–\$128,000                      | 431       | 1,000     | 325       | 855       | 257           | 741       | 369       | 830       |
| \$128,001–\$182,000                     | 607       | 1,117     | 490       | 962       | 404           | 844       | 540       | 944       |
| \$182,001 and over                      | 950       | 1,347     | 762       | 1,145     | 645           | 1,003     | 852       | 1,154     |
| <b>You &amp; Child(ren)</b>             |           |           |           |           |               |           |           |           |
| Under \$42,000                          | 117       | 686       | 71        | 589       | 51            | 518       | 88        | 563       |
| \$42,001–\$75,000                       | 216       | 751       | 152       | 641       | 97            | 550       | 197       | 635       |
| \$75,001–\$128,000                      | 366       | 850       | 272       | 721       | 215           | 630       | 319       | 717       |
| \$128,001–\$182,000                     | 516       | 952       | 411       | 815       | 338           | 711       | 466       | 815       |
| \$182,001 and over                      | 807       | 1,144     | 639       | 967       | 540           | 846       | 736       | 996       |
| <b>Family</b>                           |           |           |           |           |               |           |           |           |
| Under \$42,000                          | 208       | 1,210     | 123       | 1,038     | 88            | 917       | 156       | 986       |
| \$42,001–\$75,000                       | 382       | 1,326     | 270       | 1,137     | 172           | 973       | 346       | 1,112     |
| \$75,001–\$128,000                      | 647       | 1,503     | 488       | 1,282     | 387           | 1,117     | 562       | 1,256     |
| \$128,001–\$182,000                     | 913       | 1,681     | 735       | 1,447     | 606           | 1,263     | 821       | 1,431     |
| \$182,001 and over                      | 1,428     | 2,024     | 1,143     | 1,719     | 967           | 1,505     | 1,295     | 1,748     |

Your salary tier is determined by your salary on September 1 of the year preceding the plan year (e.g., premiums starting January 1, 2026 are based on your September 1, 2025 salary).

- Mid-year changes to your salary will not change your assigned salary tier unless you transition from full-time to part-time or part-time to full-time.
- When your September 1 salary crosses a salary tier due to a salary increase not associated with a change to full-time or part-time status, you will pay the lower premium tier for the following year.

If you are covered by a collective bargaining agreement, consult your contract for additional employee contribution information.